Agile teams like to write a short outline of the requirement in a format that's small enough to fit on an index card.[1] Teams practicing BDD often use the following format as a guideline:[2]

```
In order to <achieve a business goal or deliver business value>
As a <stakeholder>
I want <something>
```

❶ What business outcomes are you trying to achieve?

❷ Who needs it?

❸ What must you do to help achieve this outcome?

The order here is important. When you plan features and stories, your principal aim should be to deliver business value. Start out with what business value you intend to provide ❶, then who needs the feature you're proposing, ❷, and finally what feature you think will support this outcome ❸.

This helps ensure that each feature actively contributes to achieving a business goal, and so reduces the risk of scope creep. It also acts as a healthy reminder of why you're implementing this feature in the first place. For example, you could say something like this:

```
In order to plan my trips more effectively
As a commuter
I want to know the optimal itinerary between two stations
```

What business value are you trying to provide?

Who is interested in this feature?

What will the feature do?

This is not your only option. Many teams use a template popular in earlier Agile approaches:

```
As a <stakeholder>
I want <something>
So that <I can achieve some business goal>
```

❶ Who will benefit from this feature; who wants it?

❷ What does the feature do?

❸ What business value will the stakeholder get out of this feature?

This variation aims to help developers understand the context of the requirement in terms of who will be using a feature and what they expect it to do for them. The stakeholder ❶ refers to the person using the feature ❷, or who is interested in its output. The business goal ❸ identifies why this feature is needed and what value it's supposed to provide. The equivalent of the feature mentioned earlier might be something like this:

```
As a commuter
I want to know the best way to travel between two stations
So that I can get to my destination quickly
```

Both of these are handy conventions, but there's no obligation to choose one format over another, as long as you remember to express the business benefits clearly. For

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[1] These index cards can then be used to plan and visualize your progress.

[2] This format was originally proposed by Chris Matts, in the context of Feature Injection, which we'll look at in the next chapter.